

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday Feb 2, 2023

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors
Meeting #75, February 2, 2023

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:04 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (8/11): Francesco Cesarini, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Bryan Paxton, Kenneth Lundin, Miriam Pena Villanueva (joined :09, during item 2), Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, and Alistair Woodman.

The following members of the board of directors were absent: Sophie DeBenedetto, Ben Marx, Maxim Fedorov

Agenda Items

1. Approval of minutes from previous meetings.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #74 held on December 22, 2022. Unanimously approved (by the 7 members present for this item).

2. Intermediate actions and activities: none
3. Treasury update: Sebastian made a quick through of the current numbers, and status of sponsors. Membership numbers: Annual Supporting: 143 (+5), Basic 1133 (+32), Lifetime 18, Managing and Contributing: 14.
4. Unanimous consent votes: none scheduled
5. Upcoming Board election. The cohort that is up is: Sebastian Strollo (current Secretary), Fred Hebert, Alistair Woodman (current President), and Francesco Cesarini. Fred declared that he will not run for re-election. We need volunteers in the board to run the election.
6. Stipend requests:
 1. OTP PR handling from Thomas Depierre - withdrawn by requestor.

2. OTP Build System Improvements from Thomas Depierre for \$4000. This is for step 1: document current build system. It was reported that the OTP organization has reviewed the proposal and thinks it is a good idea.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the stipend request from Thomas Depierre for \$4000 to document the OTP build system. Unanimously approved.

3. Sponsorship of Erlang and Elixir forums. Proposed that we sponsor at the Diamond level (not to exceed \$4000).

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the proposal to sponsor Erlang and Elixir forums at the Diamond level, not to exceed \$4000. Unanimously approved.

7. Alistair will be at FOSDEM and discuss the EU CRA (The EU Cyber Resilience Act) as an EEF representative, none there against.
8. Budget planning 2023. Discussed budget spreadsheet to get an idea of which areas to spend money. Noted that the sponsorship goal is 100 - 150k, so far spending goal is 150k. Alistair will keep working on the spreadsheet for next meeting.
 - Francesco suggested we keep working on the job description for an administrator position, will send out link to document.
9. Any other business: None
10. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:03 UTC.

Dated February 2, 2023

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. Stipend request from Thomas Depierre (2 pages)

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : Development Work

First name : Thomas

Last Name : Depierre

Email Address : depierre.thomas@gmail.com

Country : France

Website : <https://www.softwaremaxims.com/>

Intended product of project :

A few documentation pages in the OTP repository explaining the different steps that compose the building and compilation of OTP itself. In particular focus on the way the different makefiles interact with each other, the way build_otp script interacts with it, and the different steps of bootstrapping.

Purpose

Using the build system right now is black art with not a lot of documentation. This has made porting OTP to new platforms, introducing patches, or even simply cross-compiling it in some CI really hard. It also makes it hard to introduce changes to speed it up. On top of that, the windows build fully depends on the build_otp script in some relatively obscure ways. We have also seen with Autoconf 3.14 how brittle the build system is. There are also multiple traces of capabilities of the build system that were lost over time in the various makefiles. Being able to understand the way the build system is structured should help us decide how we could get them back. (As an example, this comment was added 13 years ago <https://github.com/erlang/otp/blob/master/Makefile.in#L140>) The first step in finding solutions for these problems is to understand how the current system work and find out where the pain points that could be addressed are based on this. Existing examples of these can be found in the Rust project <https://rustc-dev-guide.rust-lang.org/building/bootstrapping.html> and the Haskell GHC projects <https://gitlab.haskell.org/ghc/ghc/-/wikis/building/#building-and-porting-ghc> under "More detailed information about how the build system works"

Development Plan

I will do the job. Mostly I will read the makefiles, autoconf, and build scripts, to produce some documentation. I would then make them visible to the member of the OTP team familiar with the compiler through a PR and shepherd any change needed from their review. I am also planning to use some tools like remake and makegrind to generate some understanding of the build graph. The first step will be to document the structure of the project, similar to <https://gitlab.haskell.org/ghc/ghc/-/wikis/commentary/source-tree> A second step will be to document the structure of the makefiles, similar to <https://>

gitlab.haskell.org/ghc/ghc/-/wikis/building/architecture Then a third step will be around the bootstrapping process. Hopefully, at this point, I may be able to document the different configure and build_otp targets and what they do, and how they interact with the build system.

Dissemination : Documentation will be in the OTP source. I will probably do a few blogpost about how I got there and the tools I used. I doubt a lot of conferences will want to hear about something as obscure as this.

Delivery Method : PR to the OTP source. The total amount is for all the steps, it may take 6 months to a year to get there, depending on time and pain point. Maybe we could make it 1k per step 1. documenting the structure of the project 2. Documenting the makefile structure and architecture 3. Documenting bootstrapping 4. Documenting build_otp and configure options for cross-compilation

Stipend Amount (USD) : 4000